

momentum phenomenon—that every trader intuitively understands and uses—to a higher level, and one that is accessible to investors of all stripes.

Why did it take so long for a book like *Dual Momentum Investing* to hit the market? The answer is straightforward: it took a unique author, and there is only one Gary. He is a singular figure in the world of momentum. My relationship with Gary was born via the same mechanism through which I meet many fascinating folks: a blog romance. I was thinking about a momentum-related content piece for TurnkeyAnalyst.com, a blog dedicated to democratizing quantitative investing, and Gary's paper "Absolute Momentum: A Simple Rule-Based Strategy and Universal Trend-Following Overlay" came across my desk. I immediately thought, "This won't do. Here we go again—another practitioner posing as a serious academic researcher." But then I read Gary's paper. The further I read, the more impressed I became. The paper was well written, clear, scientific in its construction, and read like an academic journal article. I couldn't understand why the author wasn't employed at a university. I had to learn more.

After multiple conversations via e-mail and phone, I decided I had to meet Gary in person. Consistent with how these blog romances evolve, we scheduled a "geek date" at the 2013 Western Finance Association Annual Meeting in Lake Tahoe. As I waited in the lobby of the Hyatt Regency watching herds of famous (and infamous) academics scurry along to the various sessions, a curly haired, low-profile man confidently strolled through the fancy double doors in a pair of jeans and a short-sleeved collared shirt. This was no tweed-clad academic with Coke bottle glasses. I pointed in his direction and asked, "Gary, is that you?" Gary responded with a wide smile, "Wes? Hey man, let's hurry up and catch the session on inferring arbitrage capital from return correlations!" And so it was that our curious blog relationship began to blossom into a full romance.

We were running late, so we ran out the door toward the lake where the finance sessions were under way. We arrived, sweaty and winded—probably not in a condition to open the door on an ongoing paper presentation and get the death stare from 50+ finance professors. I suggested, "Gary, let's just chill out, grab some coffee, and we can hit the next paper presentations." Little did I know, I was about to get a presentation far superior to anything that was going on behind the many closed doors.